

Interview Prep

Litmus V2 career/resume RAG knowledge-base document.

STAR

STAR stands for Situation, Task, Action, and Result, a common framework for behavioral interview answers.

Why STAR works

STAR provides context, clarifies the candidate's specific role and actions, and highlights outcomes, preventing vague or rambling responses.

Greatest weakness

Avoid disguised strengths such as "I work too hard." Give a genuine, self-aware weakness and concrete steps taken to improve it.

Questions for interviewer

Candidates should prepare thoughtful questions. Having none can signal disengagement; questions about the team, role, or company are appropriate.

System design

Jumping straight to code skips requirements, scale, constraints, goals, and trade-offs. Clarify requirements first, then discuss high-level architecture and trade-offs before implementation details.

Technical screening

A technical screening verifies baseline technical competency early, often through a short coding or knowledge-based call, before longer onsite or panel interviews.

Salary timing

Salary negotiation is generally reserved for after a formal offer rather than early interview rounds.

After interview

Within 24 hours, send a personalized thank-you email, reiterate interest, and reference something specific discussed.

Behavioral vs technical

Behavioral interviews assess soft skills, past conduct, teamwork, conflict resolution, adaptability, communication, and cultural fit. Technical interviews assess applied problem solving and domain knowledge such as coding or system design. Companies may use both because technical competence alone does not guarantee collaboration or communication.

Mock interview

A mock interview is a practice interview with a friend, mentor, or coach that simulates the real experience, builds confidence, and provides feedback.